

MIND MAPPING

Student Handout • Fundamentals of Study and Employability

Prepared by Upama Rai

Purpose of this handout

This handout shows how to move from researched notes to an effective visual mind map. The worked topic is “The Impact of Artificial Intelligence on the Future of Employment in the Computing Industry”.

What makes an effective mind map?

FEATURE	GOOD PRACTICE
Central image	Use a clear central image and a short topic title.
Radiating structure	Develop major ideas as branches moving outward from the centre.
Hierarchy	Use thick main branches, then thinner supporting branches.
Keywords	Prefer one keyword or a very short phrase on each branch.
Colour coding	Give each main branch its own consistent colour.
Visual cues	Add small icons, simple drawings and symbols where they support meaning.
Mnemonics	Group related ideas into memorable patterns such as SAIL and CARE.
Cross-links	Use selected arrows to show cause, effect or another important relationship.
Evidence tags	Add brief tags such as WEF 2025 or ILO 2025 beside researched points.
White space	Leave enough space for each branch to remain readable.

Evidence-informed note

A meta-analysis of 21 studies reported a more positive influence of mind-mapping instruction on cognitive learning outcomes than traditional instruction. The study also describes mind maps as a central image with major themes, keywords and connected branches.

HOW TO BUILD THE MAP

From research notes to a visual study tool

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1. Define the focus

Full topic: The Impact of Artificial Intelligence on the Future of Employment in the Computing Industry. Focus question: How might AI change jobs, skills and human contribution in computing?

2. Shorten the centre

Use “AI AND EMPLOYMENT” in the middle. The full title can appear below in smaller writing.

3. Group the research

Sort the notes into six meaningful categories: Impact on Jobs, New Opportunities, Skills Needed, Risks and Challenges, Preparation, and Human Contribution.

4. Choose keywords

Reduce full notes to memorable words such as automation, transformed, oversight, innovation, reskilling, judgement and ethics.

5. Build the hierarchy

Main branch → sub-branch → supporting keyword or example. Avoid a flat list where every item appears equally important.

6. Add memory features

Place SAIL with Skills Needed, CARE with Human Contribution, and short trigger phrases near the relevant branches.

7. Add selected links

Show only relationships that improve understanding, such as Risks → Preparation and Skills → Opportunities.

8. Test the map

Cover the notes and explain every branch aloud. Redraw the map from memory, then correct any missing ideas.

Avoid these common problems

Do not use long paragraphs, identical straight boxes, too many colours, decorative icons with no meaning, disconnected branches or copied text that the student cannot explain.

PLAN THE CONTENT

AI AND EMPLOYMENT

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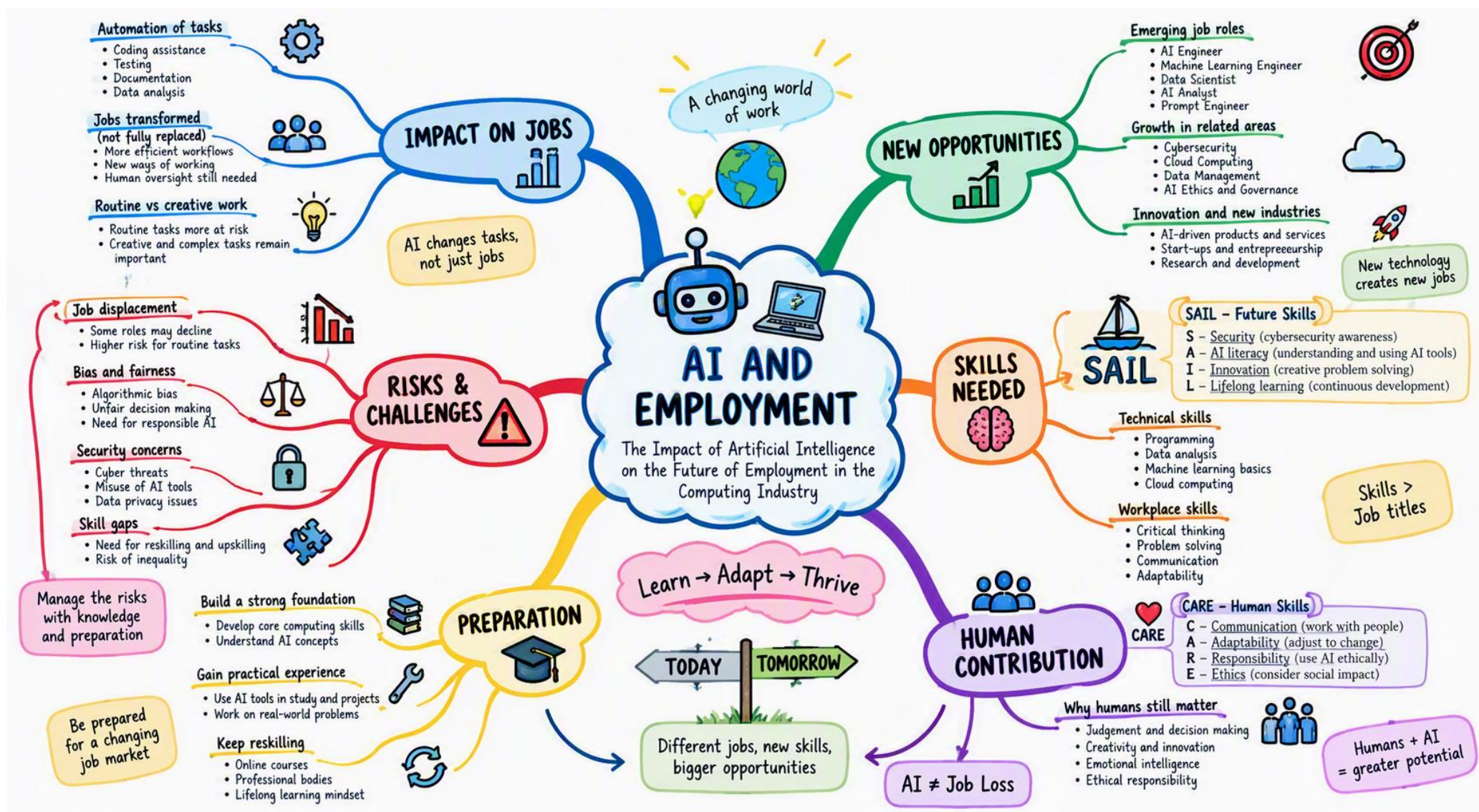
MAIN BRANCH	SUB-BRANCHES	MEMORY FEATURE	LINK
Impact on Jobs	Automation • Transformation • Human oversight	AI changes tasks, not just jobs	Connect to Human Contribution
New Opportunities	Emerging roles • Related growth • Innovation	New technology creates new jobs	Connect from Skills Needed
Skills Needed	Technical • Workplace • Continuous learning	SAIL	Connect to Opportunities
Risks & Challenges	Displacement • Bias • Security • Skill gaps	Manage risk with knowledge	Connect to Preparation
Preparation	Foundations • Practice • Reskilling	Learn → Adapt → Thrive	Connect from Risks
Human Contribution	Judgement • Creativity • Ethics	CARE	Connect to Impact on Jobs

Mnemonics

SAIL • Future skills	CARE • Human contribution
S = Security A = AI literacy I = Innovation L = Lifelong learning	C = Communication A = Adaptability R = Responsibility E = Ethics
Memory triggers AI ≠ job loss only • Humans + AI • Skills > job titles • Learn → Adapt → Thrive	

FINAL WORKED MIND MAP

AI AND EMPLOYMENT



Use the diagram as a model of visual structure. Students should recreate the content in their own layout and be able to explain every branch.

HOW TO STUDY WITH THE MAP

The final diagram is a revision tool, not just a drawing

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Explain

Point to each main branch and explain the connected keywords in complete sentences.

Cover and recall

Cover one area of the map and reconstruct it from memory.

Redraw

Create the map again on blank paper without looking at the original.

Compare

Check the new version against the model and identify missing or unclear links.

Question

Turn branches into questions, for example: “Why does human oversight still matter?”

Apply

Add one new computing example to each branch, such as AI-assisted coding, automated testing or cybersecurity monitoring.

References used for the handout

- Shi, Y., Yang, H., Dou, Y. and Zeng, Y. (2022), “Effects of mind mapping-based instruction on student cognitive learning outcomes: a meta-analysis”.
- World Economic Forum (2025), The Future of Jobs Report 2025.
- International Labour Organization (2025), Generative AI and jobs: A 2025 update.

Final student checklist

☐ Strong central image and short title ☐ Curved or radiating branches ☐ Clear hierarchy ☐ Keywords rather than paragraphs ☐ Consistent colours ☐ Helpful icons ☐ SAIL and CARE used correctly ☐ Selected cross-links ☐ Evidence tags where needed ☐ Every branch can be explained

BLANK DESIGN PLANNER

Plan before drawing the final mind map

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Full topic: _____

Central image/title: _____

Focus question: _____

Mnemonics: _____ Memory triggers: _____

BRANCH	KEYWORDS	ICON	COLOUR	CROSS-LINK
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Self-test

Can you redraw the main structure and explain each branch without reading your notes?